DOCUMENTATION · VERSION 1.3

# Montage Studio Video

The video editor that makes your Shorts, Reels, TikToks and YouTube videos on your own computer, by hand or in batches, with no subscription and without sending your files to the Internet.




**0 – 3 s** Animated intro

**3 – 8 s** Title, subtitles, logo

**8 – 11 s** Animated photo, text

**11 – 14.5 s** End screen

**4** image formats

**7** animated scenes

**3** voice-over engines

**4** languages

**100%** local

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AT A GLANCE

# A complete editing studio built for short formats

Montage Studio Video (MSV) is made for content creators, small teams and companies that publish videos on social media regularly. It brings together in one application what usually takes several tools: editing, titles and subtitles, voice-over, music, animated scenes and batch production.

The four frames above come from a 14.5-second Short made entirely by MSV: an animated intro, a video with a title and karaoke subtitles, an animated photo and a “Subscribe” end screen, all over generated music. It was rendered in **15.5 seconds**, at 1080 × 1920, on a laptop (13th-generation Intel Core i7).

### Manual editing

Cut, crop and join your videos and photos; add titles, subtitles, a logo and transitions.

### Batch production

A CSV table or a folder becomes dozens of videos in the same style, with no manual work.

### Voice-over and music

Free synthetic voices, ElevenLabs, or your own voice cloned on your PC. Royalty-free music generated to the right length.

### Animated scenes

Intro, end screen, list, key figures, before / after, hook question: ready-made animations you just fill in.

INSTALLATION

# Installing and starting MSV

| System | How to install |
|---|---|
| **Windows 10 or 11** (64-bit) | Run the installer `MontageStudioVideo-<version>-Setup.exe`, then open *Montage Studio Video* from the Start menu. No administrator rights are needed and Python does not need to be installed. |
| **macOS and Linux** | With Python 3.11 or newer, run the `lancer_mac_linux.sh` script. |

On first launch, MSV downloads its components (about 400 MB, only once). The FFmpeg video engine is included, so there is nothing else to install. The application then opens in your browser at `http://127.0.0.1:7860`, an address that can only be reached from your own computer.

| Where your files are (installed version) | Content |
|---|---|
| `Documents\Montage Studio Video` | Your imported media, your finished videos, your projects and your templates |
| `%LOCALAPPDATA%\MontageStudioVideo` | Internal files: components, cache, downloaded voices, ElevenLabs key |

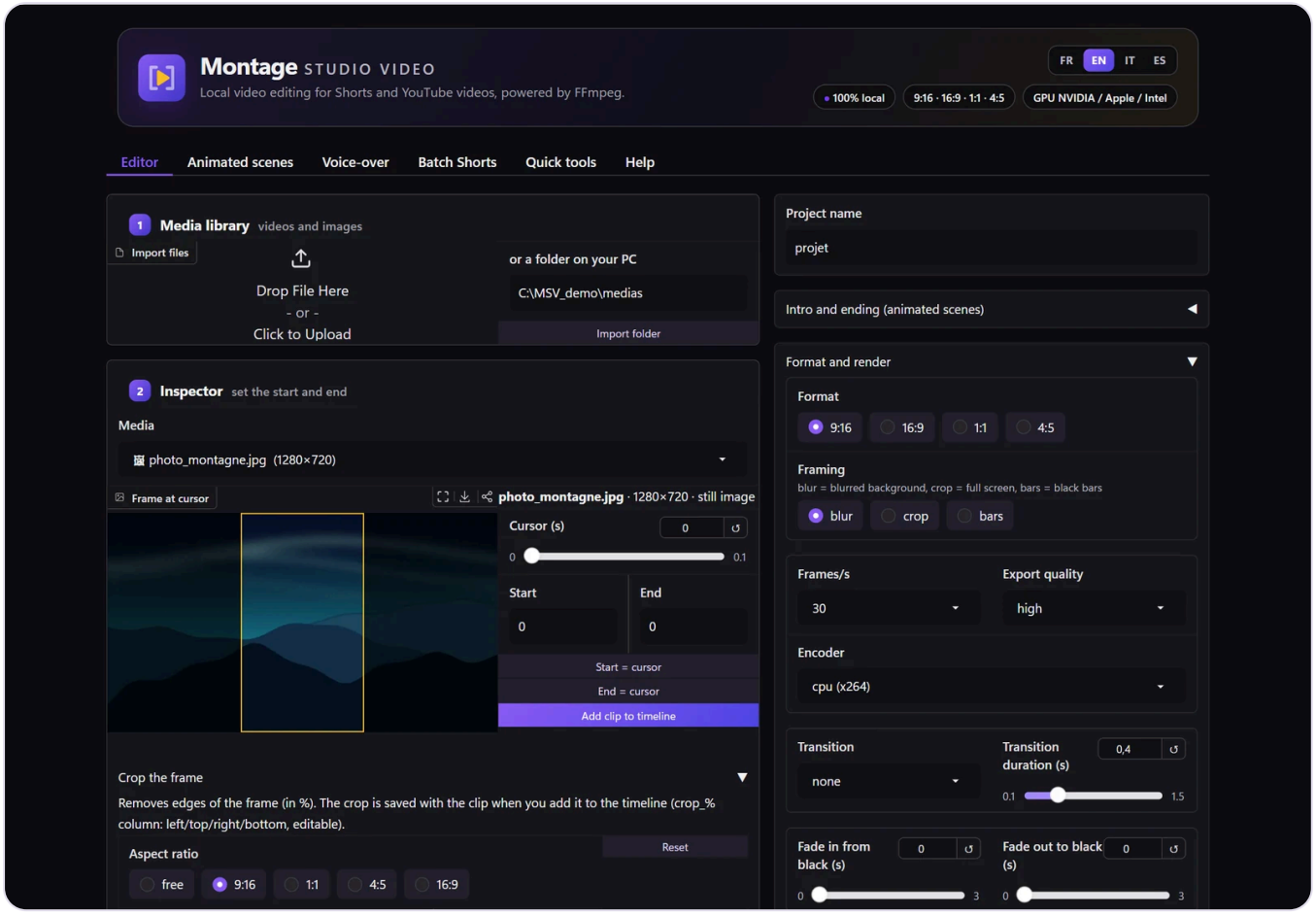
**Recommended setup.** A recent computer is enough for editing. An NVIDIA, Apple or Intel graphics card speeds up export. Cloning your own voice works best with an NVIDIA card; this documentation was produced on a 13th-generation Core i7 laptop with 16 GB of memory and an RTX 4060.

As long as the installer is not digitally signed, Windows may show “Windows protected your PC”: click *More info*, then *Run anyway*.

GETTING STARTED

# The interface

Everything happens in a single window, organized in six tabs. The selector at the top right changes the interface language: French, English, Italian or Spanish.




The Editor tab: media library and inspector on the left, project settings on the right.

| Tab | What it is for |
|---|---|
| **Editor** | Build a video: import, cut, crop, add layers, title, subtitles and audio, then export. |
| **Animated scenes** | Create animated sequences (intro, end screen, list…) and add them to the edit. |
| **Voice-over** | Turn a text into a voice, with synchronized subtitles. |
| **Batch Shorts** | Automatically produce one video per row of a table or per file in a folder. |
| **Quick tools** | YouTube thumbnail, conversion to a Short, audio extraction, transcription, logo removal. |
| **Help** | A short user guide, in the selected language. |

EDITOR TAB

# Editing a video, step by step

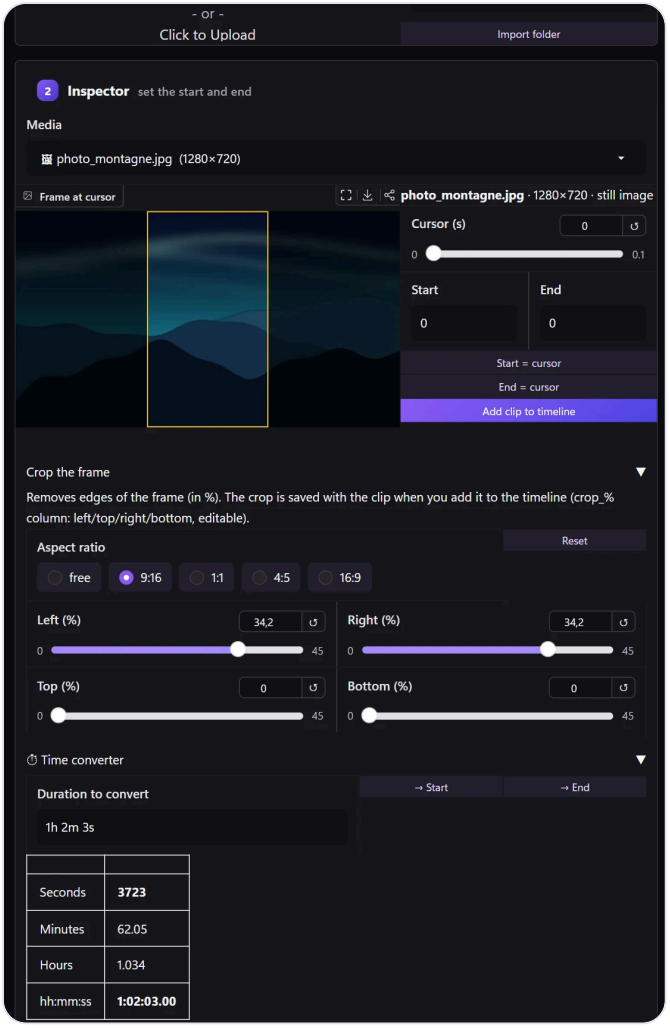
## 1 Import your media

Drop your videos, photos and audio files into the **media library**, or point to a folder on your computer to import everything at once. Dropped files are copied into the MSV working folder and stay available from one session to the next; a folder you point to is used in place, without copying.

## 2 Choose where each clip starts and ends

In the **inspector**, move the cursor frame by frame, then set the start and end with “Start = cursor” and “End = cursor”. Two helpers complete the inspector:

- **Crop the frame**: remove edges (in %), or keep the largest area in 9:16, 1:1, 4:5 or 16:9 in one click. The kept area is outlined on the image.
- **Time converter**: type “1h 2m 3s”, “1:30” or “2,5 min” and MSV shows the equivalent in seconds, minutes and hours, and can copy it into the start or end field.



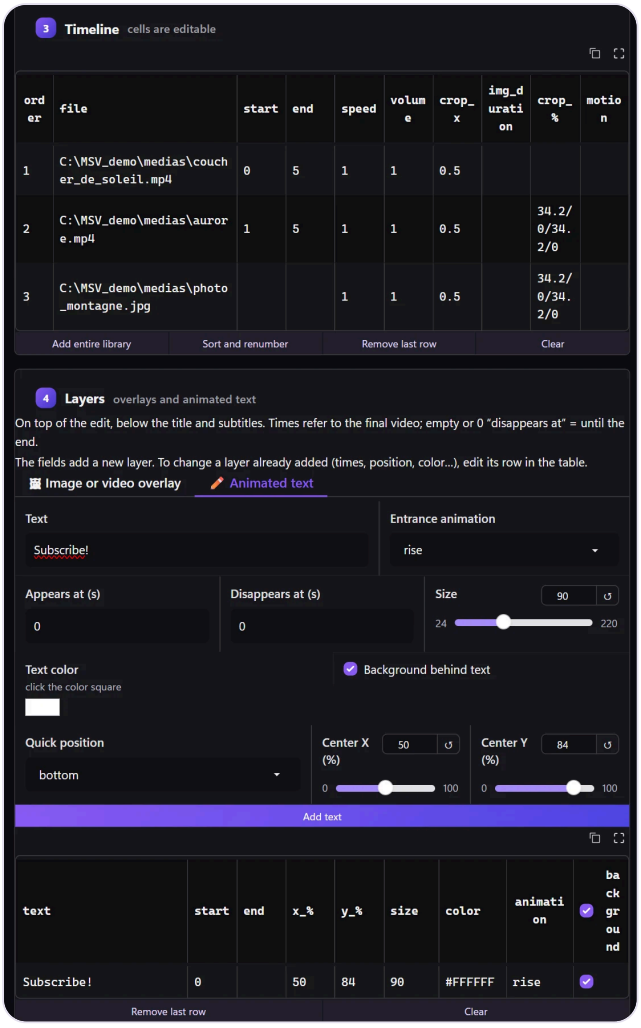

Inspector: 9:16 crop and time converter (1 h 2 min 3 s = 3,723 s).

## 3 Arrange the timeline and add layers

Each clip becomes a row of the **timeline**. Cells are edited directly: order, start, end, speed (from 0.1 to 4), volume, horizontal framing, photo duration, crop and photo motion.

The **Layers** section adds elements on top of the video, each with its own appear and disappear times:

- **Image or video overlay**: logo, sticker, screenshot or picture-in-picture video. Opaque images and videos get rounded corners.
- **Animated text**: as many texts as you need, with size, color, background and position.
- Each layer has an entrance animation of your choice: *fade*, *rise* or *zoom* with a slight bounce.




A timeline of three clips (two videos and a photo) and an animated text, "Subscribe!", rising at the bottom of the frame.

## 4 Set the format and framing

Choose the output format: **9:16** (1080 × 1920, Shorts, Reels, TikTok), **16:9** (1920 × 1080, YouTube), **1:1** (1080 × 1080) or **4:5** (1080 × 1350). When a video does not have the right proportions, three framing modes are available:



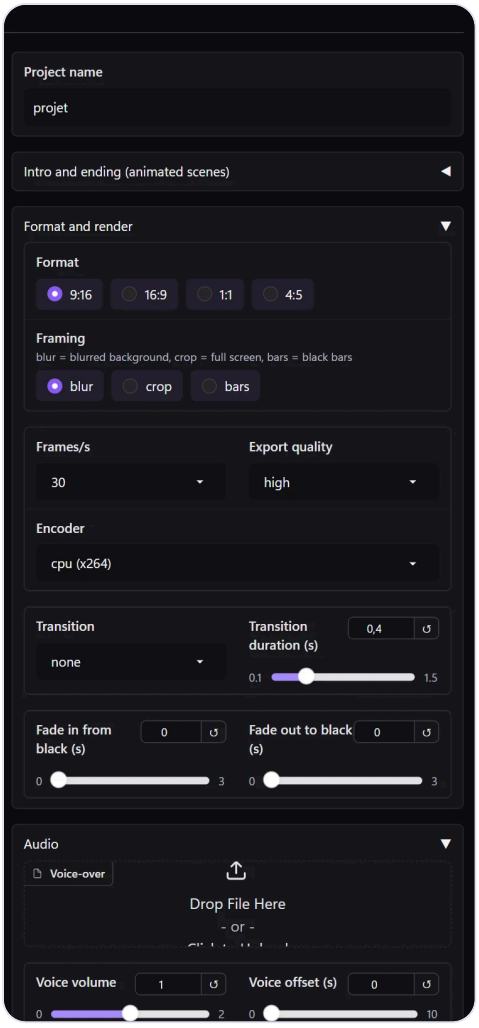
**Blur**
Whole image on a blurred background

**Crop**
Full screen, sides cut

**Bars**
Black bars

The same settings define the **transitions** between clips (crossfade, fade to black, dissolve, slide left or up, wipe, zoom, circle), their duration, and the fade in from or out to black.

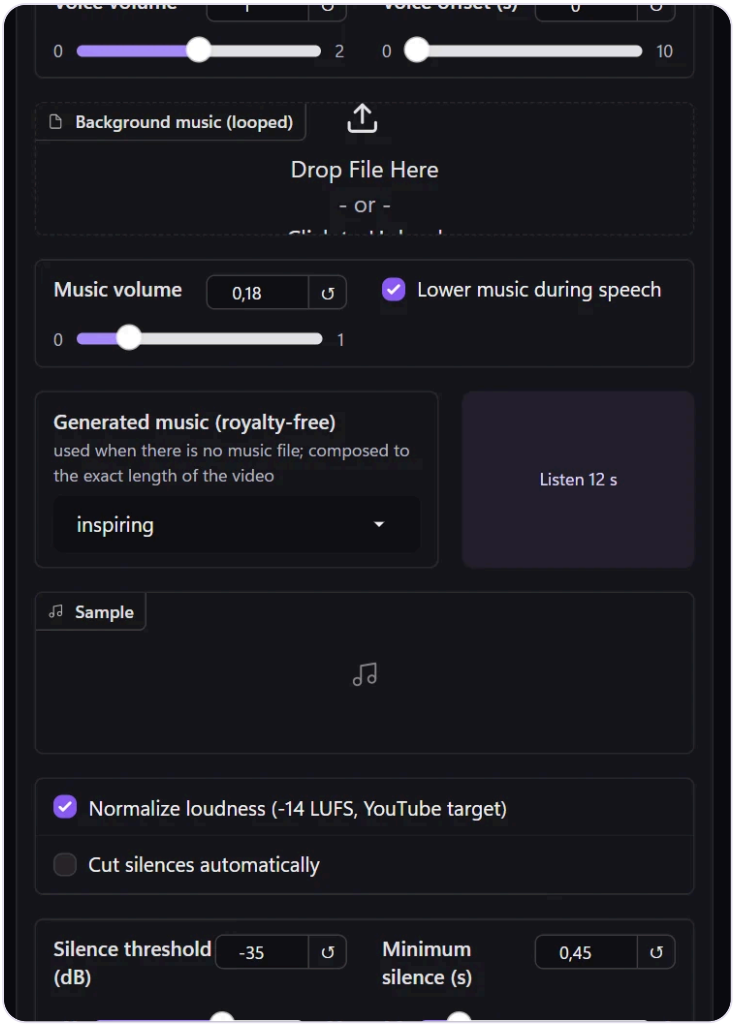
For photos, **motion** (the Ken Burns effect) animates the image: zoom in or out, pan left or right, or “Ken Burns”, which combines a slow zoom and a drift with a different path for each photo. The timeline's “motion” column sets the motion of a single photo.




Format, framing, frames per second, quality, encoder and transitions.

## 5 Add sound: voice-over, music, clean-up

- **Voice-over**: an audio file, its volume and its offset. It can come from the Voice-over tab in one click.
- **Background music**: your own file, looped over the whole video, or **generated music**: royalty-free, composed on your PC to the exact length of the video. Four moods: calm, inspiring, energetic, suspense. The “Listen 12 s” button plays a sample.
- **Ducking**: the music is lowered automatically while someone speaks.
- **Loudness normalization** to -14 LUFS, the level YouTube targets.
- **Silence removal**: gaps in a filmed video are cut automatically (adjustable threshold and duration).



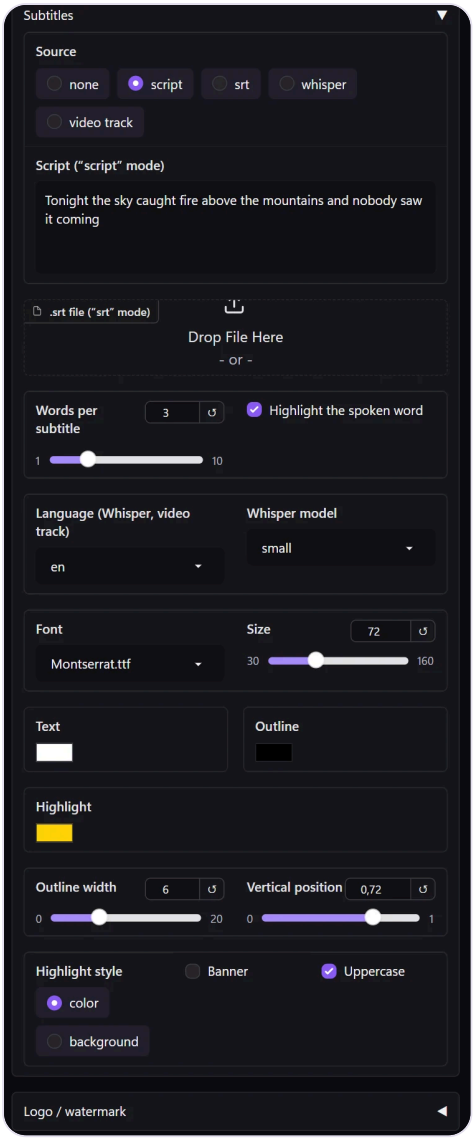

“Inspiring” generated music, music lowered during speech, normalized loudness.

## 6 Title and subtitles

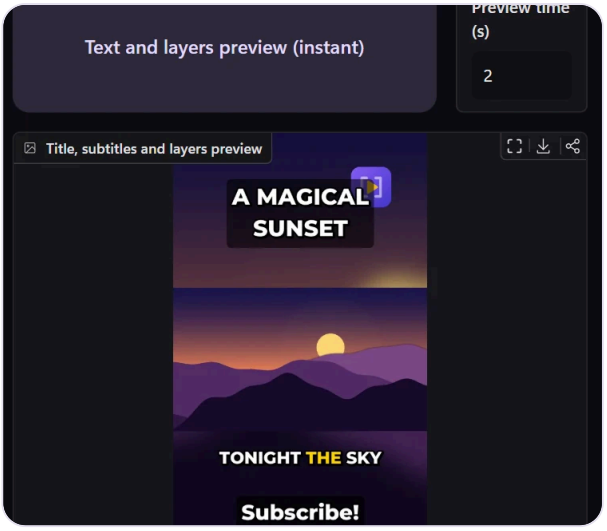
The **title** appears at the times you choose, with its font, color, size, position and an optional banner. **Subtitles** have five possible sources:

| Source | How it works |
|---|---|
| **script** | You paste the text; MSV splits and times it automatically, over the length of the voice-over if there is one. |
| **srt** | An existing subtitle file, for example the one produced by the Voice-over tab. |
| **whisper** | Automatic word-level transcription of what is said (optional module, installed once). |
| **video** | Subtitles already embedded in the file (MP4, MKV), in the chosen language, re-timed after cuts. |
| **none** | No subtitles. |

**Karaoke** mode highlights the word being spoken. Words per subtitle, font, colors, outline, position and capitals are all adjustable. An `.srt` file is always exported next to the video.




"script" source, karaoke and style.

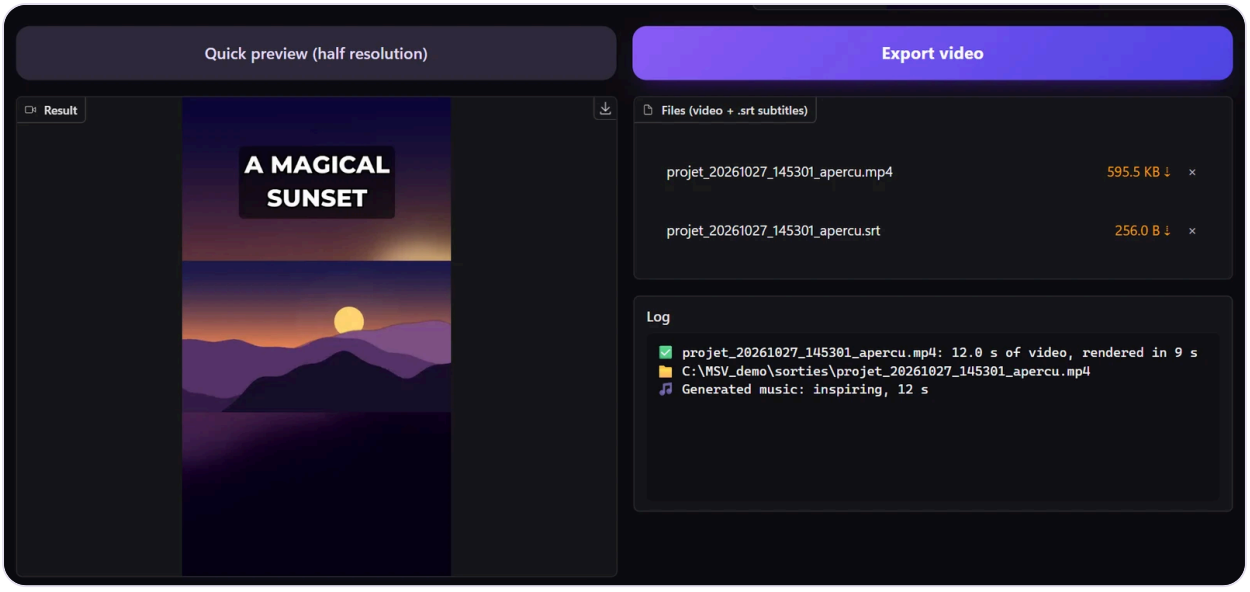



The instant preview shows the title, subtitles and layers visible at the chosen moment, without waiting for a render.

A **logo or watermark** (a transparent PNG works best) can also be placed in one of the four corners or in the center, with its size and opacity.

## 7 Preview and export

**Quick preview** renders the video at half resolution in a few seconds, to check the edit. **Export video** produces the final file: MP4 (H.264 and AAC), ready to publish, with its `.srt` file. Three quality levels are available (preview, standard, high). Export can use the graphics card (NVIDIA, Apple or Intel); if it is not available, MSV automatically falls back to the processor.



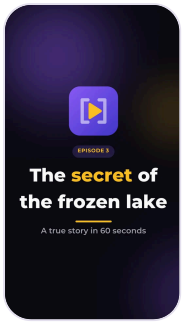

Quick preview: 12 seconds of video rendered in 9 seconds, including the generated music. The log lists each step.

In “Projects and templates”, a project can be saved and reloaded, and its settings can become a reusable **template** for batch production.

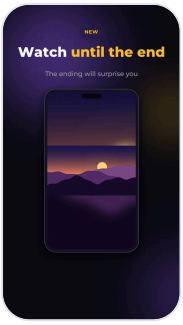
ANIMATED SCENES TAB

# Ready-made animations you fill in

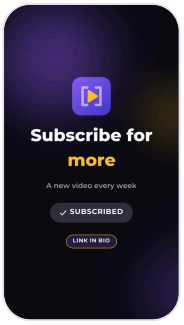
Animated scenes give your videos the motion-design look of professional content without specialized software. You choose a scene, fill in its texts, and MSV makes a video clip in the format of your choice. A word written between asterisks, such as `*more*`, takes the accent color.




**Title card**
Bouncing logo, title, color line



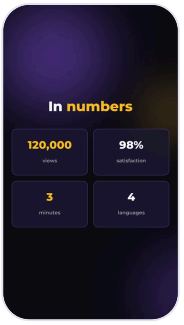

**Phone**
Your video inside a phone



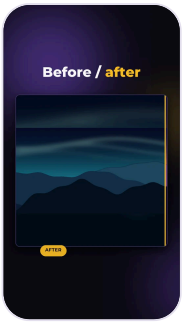

**End screen**
“Subscribe” button gets clicked



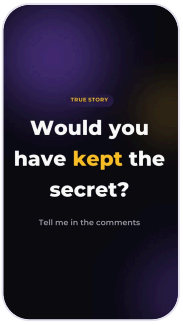

**List**
Points checked one by one



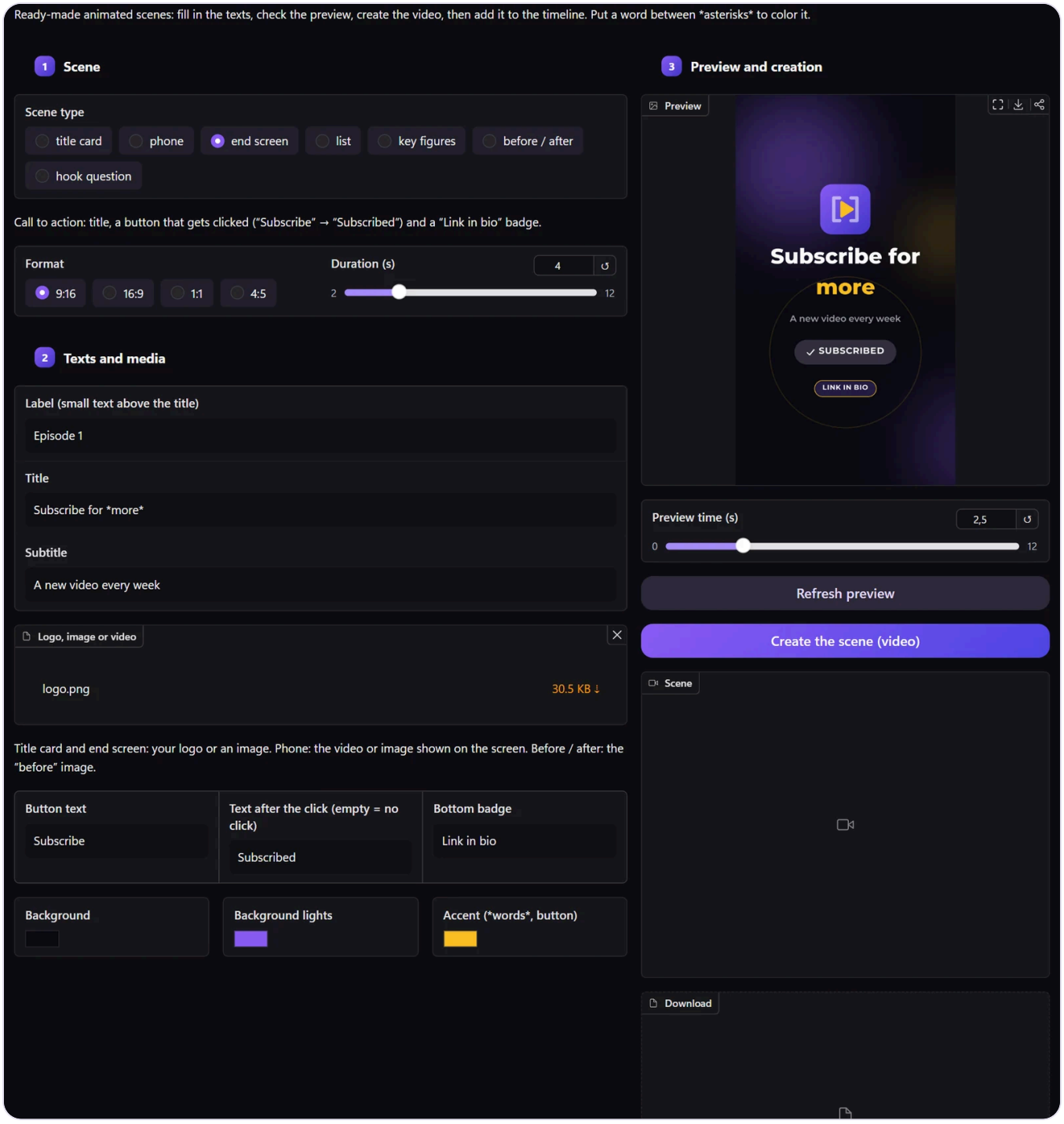

**Key figures**
Numbers count up




**Before / after**
Wipe between two media




**Hook question**
Words drop in one by one




Setting up an end screen: texts, logo, colors, duration and an instant preview at any moment.

## Using a scene

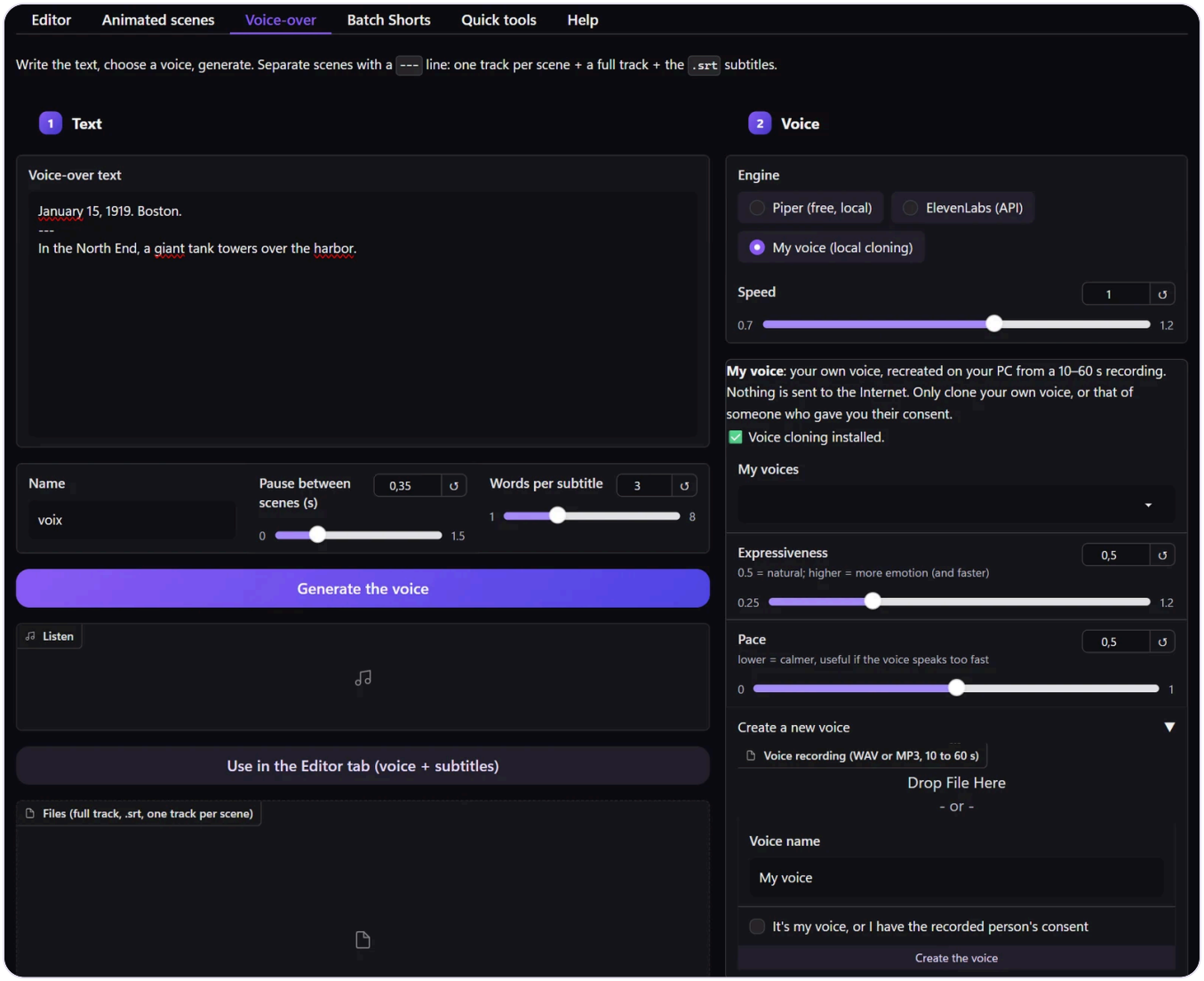
- **Create the scene** makes an MP4 clip (a 4-second scene at 1080 × 1920 takes about 7 seconds), then **Add to timeline** places it at the end of the edit.
- **Use as project intro / ending** adds the scene automatically to every render, in the project format. The voice-over, title and subtitles are shifted to start after the intro.
- If the text is long or the format small, the scene shrinks itself so that nothing goes off screen.

VOICE-OVER TAB

# Turning a text into a voice

Write the narration. A line containing only `---` separates scenes: MSV produces one track per scene, a full track and a synchronized `.srt` subtitle file. One button sends the voice and its subtitles straight to the Editor tab.

| Engine | Quality | Cost | Where it runs |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Piper** | Decent. 9 voices in French, English and Spanish, all licensed for commercial use. | Free | On your PC, offline |
| **ElevenLabs** | Very natural, exactly timed subtitles, your ElevenLabs voices available. | ElevenLabs subscription | Online service (API key) |
| **My voice** local cloning | Very good: your own voice, recreated from a 10 to 60-second recording. | Free | On your PC, offline |




The “My voice” engine: your voices, expressiveness, pace and creation of a new voice.

## Cloning your voice

1. Record 30 to 60 seconds of your voice in a quiet room, in the tone of your videos.
2. In “Create a new voice”, add the recording, give it a name and tick the consent box.
3. Then pick the voice like any other. Two settings adjust the result: **expressiveness** and **pace**.

**Consent and transparency.** Only clone your own voice, or the voice of someone who gave their consent. Every generated audio carries an inaudible watermark that identifies it as synthetic. The recording and the cloned voice stay on your computer.

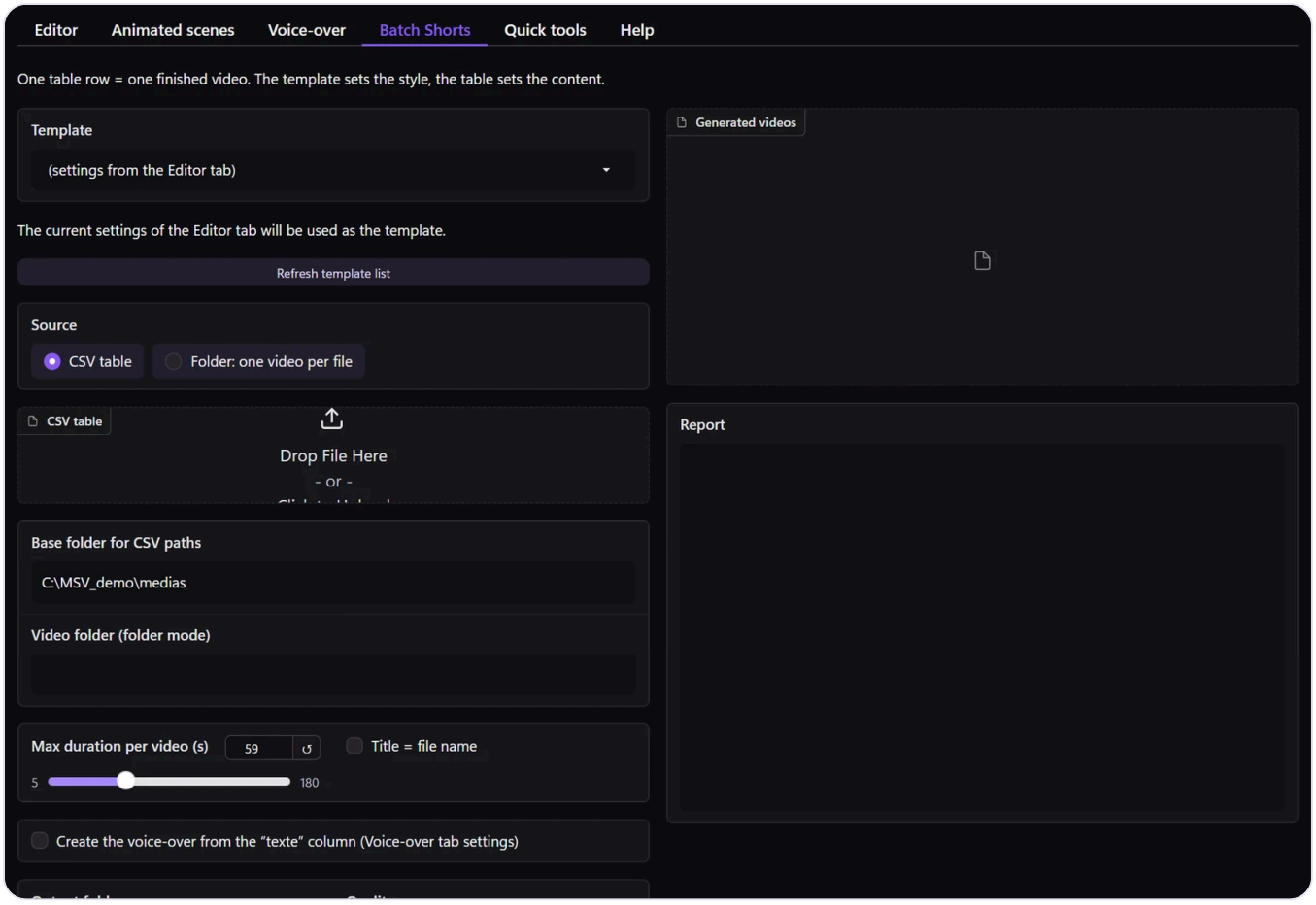
First use installs the cloning engine (about 5 GB, only once). On an NVIDIA RTX 4060, the first sentence takes about 45 seconds (model loading included), the following ones a few seconds.

**Replace the voice of an existing clip** fixes a scene that is already edited: the original voice is removed and the new one is placed at the chosen time, at the same volume as a reference clip.

BATCH SHORTS TAB

# Dozens of videos in the same style

The principle: **the template sets the style, the table sets the content**. One row of the table gives one finished video. The template can be the Editor tab settings or a bundled template: Short from a filmed video, narrative Short (storytelling), Short for toddlers, 16:9 YouTube video.




Choice of template, CSV table (or a folder of videos) and output folder.

```
id;medias;titre;texte;voix_off;musique;intro;outro
story_01;stories/01/*.jpg;The frozen lake;Tonight, I'll tell you...;;auto:suspense;The *secret* | episode 1;Subscribe
story_02;stories/02;The Boston tank;January 15, 1919...;;auto:suspense;The *wave* | episode 2;Subscribe
```

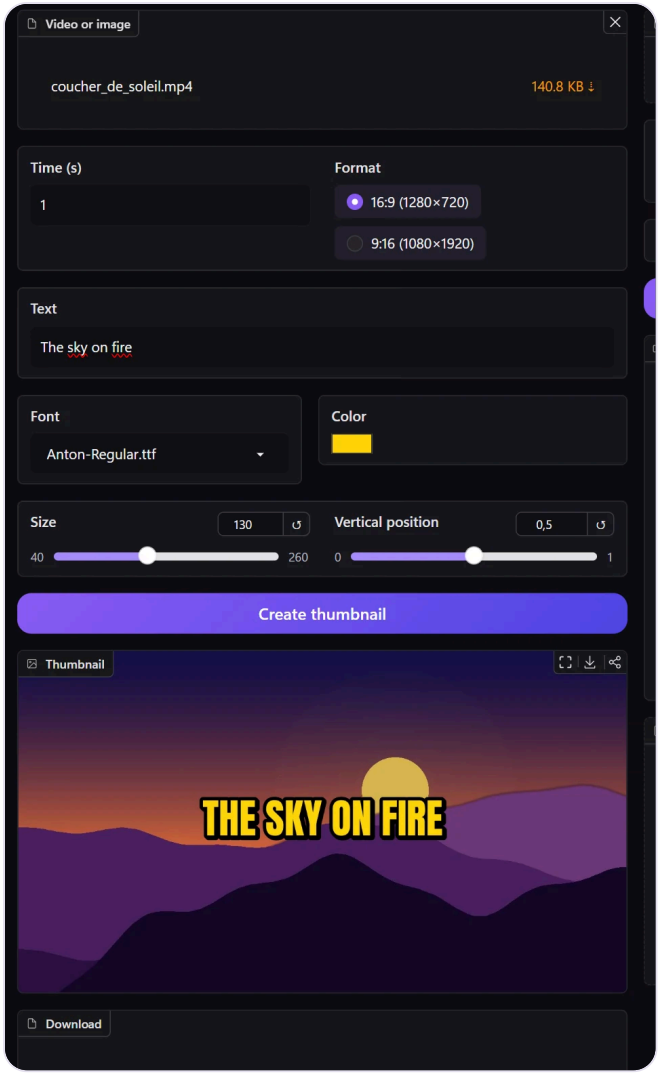
Column names stay in French in every language.

| Column | Content |
|---|---|
| `id` | Name of the output file |
| `medias` | Files separated by `\|`, a whole folder, or a pattern such as `images/*.jpg` |
| `titre` | Title shown at the start |
| `texte` | Subtitle script; MSV can also turn it into the voice-over automatically |
| `srt`, `voix_off` | Subtitle file, narration file |
| `musique` | A file, or `auto` / `auto:suspense` for generated music |
| `debut`, `fin` | Part of the videos to keep (in seconds) |
| `recadrage` | % removed from each edge: left/top/right/bottom, for example `10/0/10/0` |
| `intro`, `outro` | “Title \| subtitle” of an opening and closing animated scene, in the template's style |

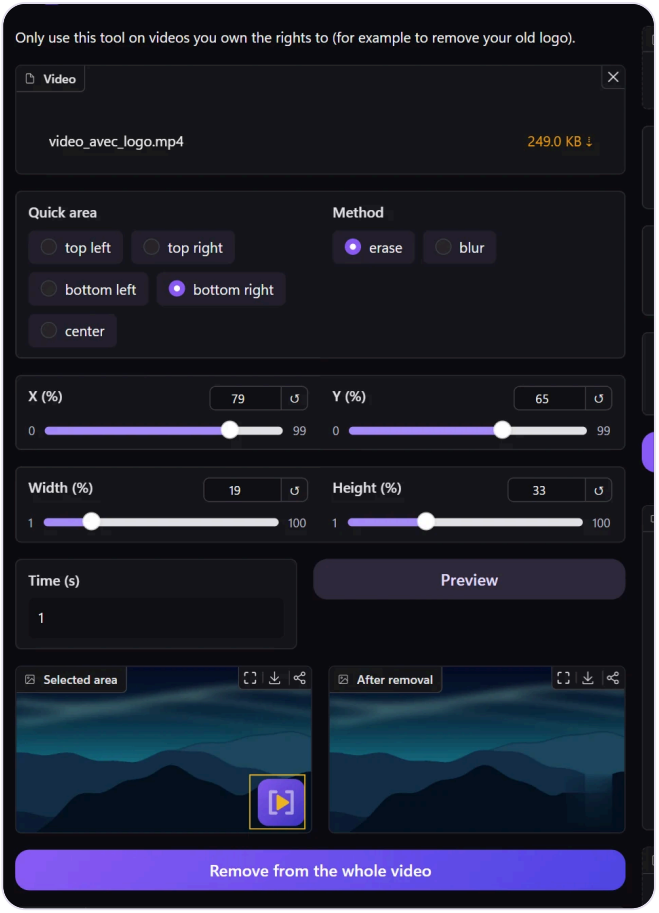
When a row contains photos and a voice-over, the photos are spread automatically over the length of the voice. **Folder** mode turns every video in a folder into a Short (adjustable maximum length, optional title from the file name). A row with an error does not stop the batch: the report shows what succeeded and what failed.

QUICK TOOLS TAB

# Everyday tasks in one click




YouTube thumbnail: a frame of the video and big text, in 16:9 (1280 × 720) or 9:16.



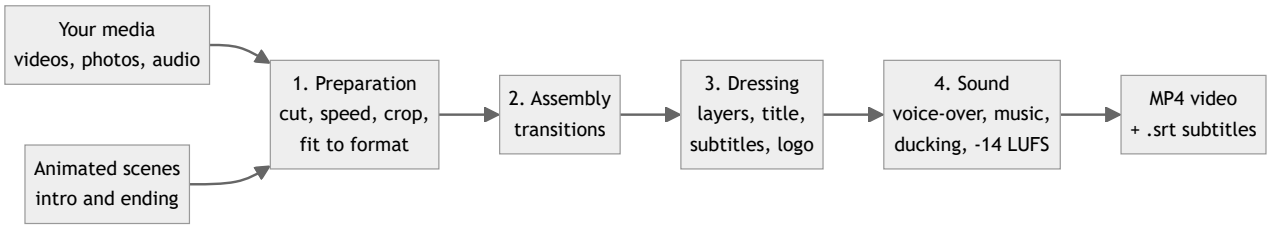

Remove a logo: chosen area, before and after preview, then processing of the whole video.

| Tool | What it does |
| --- | --- |
| **YouTube thumbnail** | A frame of the video at the chosen time, with text font, size, color and position. |
| **Video → 9:16 Short** | One-click conversion, with framing of your choice, maximum length and silences removed. |
| **Extract audio** | The sound of a video as an MP3. |
| **Transcribe to .srt** | Automatic subtitles for an audio or video file with Whisper (optional module). |
| **Remove a logo** | Erases or blurs an area (logo, watermark, text) over the whole video, with a preview. Only for videos you own the rights to. |
| **MSV logo** | Adds your logo and stores its position in the video, so it can be removed cleanly later. |

UNDER THE HOOD

# How a video is made

MSV relies on FFmpeg, the reference tool for video processing, and draws text and animations with the Pillow library. The result is therefore identical on Windows, macOS and Linux. Every export goes through these steps:




1. **Preparation**: each clip is cut, sped up or slowed down, cropped and fitted to the output format (blur, crop or bars). Photos are animated. Silences are removed if the option is on. The animated intro and ending are made at this stage.
2. **Assembly**: the clips are joined, with the chosen transitions on both picture and sound.
3. **Dressing**: layers, title, subtitles and logo are placed on top, each at its own times.
4. **Sound**: voice-over and music are mixed; the music is lowered while someone speaks and the loudness is normalized.

| Feature | Value |
|---|---|
| Output formats | 9:16 (1080 × 1920), 16:9 (1920 × 1080), 1:1 (1080 × 1080), 4:5 (1080 × 1350) |
| Output file | MP4, H.264 video, AAC audio, fast web start (“faststart”), `.srt` subtitles |
| Frames per second | 24, 25, 30 or 60 |
| Loudness | Normalized to -14 LUFS (YouTube level) |
| Hardware acceleration | NVIDIA NVENC, Apple VideoToolbox, Intel Quick Sync, with automatic fallback to the processor |
| Interface languages | French, English, Italian, Spanish |
| Automation | Command line to render a project, a CSV batch, a folder or a voice-over |

## Errors that explain themselves

When something goes wrong, MSV does not show a technical message. It says what happened and what to do, for example:

**Timeline row 1: the end (2 s) is before the start (5 s).**

What to do: fix the “start” and “end” columns; the end must be greater than the start (leave “end” empty to go to the end of the file).

Input mistakes (badly written time, crop or CSV file), impossible values (missing file, end before start) and computer problems (damaged file or file open elsewhere, full disk, no Internet) each have their own explanation. Technical details are kept in a log, useful when asking for support.

PRIVACY AND SECURITY

# Your files stay with you

- **100% local processing**: editing, rendering, Piper voices, cloned voice and generated music all run on your computer, even offline.
- **No usage statistics** are sent.
- **The Internet is used only if you choose it**: for ElevenLabs, and for the first download of a Piper voice, the Whisper model or the cloning engine.
- **Closed to other websites**: the interface can only be reached from your computer and refuses requests coming from other websites, as well as being displayed inside a third-party page.
- **Protected internal files**: the application code, your ElevenLabs key and your cloned voices cannot be downloaded from the interface.

CURRENT LIMITS

# What MSV does not do (yet)

- No drag-and-drop graphical timeline with live playback: editing happens in a table, with an instant preview and a quick video preview.
- Animations are ready-made templates (scenes, layer entrances): there is no free frame-by-frame animation as in motion-design software.
- Whisper transcription is an optional module, installed once.
- Voice cloning needs about 5 GB and is fastest with an NVIDIA graphics card.
- Generated music offers four moods; for a specific track, use your own file.

FAQ

# Frequently asked questions

**Is an Internet connection required?**

Only for installation and the first downloads (components, voices, models). After that, MSV works offline, unless you use ElevenLabs.

**Is there a subscription?**

No. MSV is free software (GPL v3 license). Only ElevenLabs, which is optional, is a paid service.

**Can I publish the videos I make, including for commercial use?**

Yes. The Piper voices offered all have licenses that allow commercial use, the generated music is composed on your PC, and the bundled fonts (Montserrat, Anton) are under the free SIL OFL license. You remain responsible for the rights to your own media.

**How long can a video be?**

MSV is optimized for short formats but also produces 16:9 YouTube videos several minutes long. Render time depends on length and chosen quality; the quick preview lets you check before the final export.

**Are my projects saved?**

A project is saved in one click (a `.json` file) and reloaded later. Its settings can also become a batch template.

**Can production be automated?**

Yes, with the Batch Shorts tab or the command line, which renders a project, a CSV batch, a folder or a voice-over without opening the interface.

Montage Studio Video · version 1.3 · free software under the GPL v3 license. Third-party components: FFmpeg (GPL v3), Gradio (Apache 2.0), Pillow, NumPy, pandas, sherpa-onnx (Apache 2.0), Chatterbox (MIT). Screenshots taken with the English interface and demo media.